

Alexander Key

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Full-stack developer with 10+ years building and running production Ruby on Rails applications end to end — architecture, payments, mobile apps with Hotwire Native, and the Linux servers they run on.

Experience

Lead Full-Stack Developer · Freelance / Contract 2016 – Present

88 Restaurants — Lead Developer 2020 – Present

- Built and scaled a restaurant management platform to **100+ restaurants** and **\$250K+ in annual revenue** by leading a small team of developers from architecture through launch — owning the full stack from Rails application code to production servers and CI/deployment.
- Processed **8 figures in payment volume** by architecting the online ordering system end to end — Stripe checkout and refunds, Uber delivery integration, order scheduling, and a full catering system.
- Delivered the platform's most complex feature — live table management — by building real-time table-state synchronization across every device in the restaurant using ActionCable WebSockets, giving front-of-house staff a single live view of the floor.

Reservation Genie — Lead Developer 2016 – Present

- Grew from front-end developer building static sites to lead developer running a small team over a **9-year engagement** by progressively taking ownership of the platform's back end, infrastructure, and technical roadmap.
- Modernized a legacy Rails 3 reservation platform by leading a ground-up rewrite to **Rails 8** in 2025 — architecting the new application and building its production infrastructure from scratch, including Dokku server provisioning and a full CI/CD pipeline.
- Expanded the platform into a new vertical — tour and boat charter operators — by designing and building an end-to-end private charter product: embeddable lead-capture widget, prioritized booking pipeline, quote/deposit/balance invoicing, digital waivers, and crew assignment with automated itineraries.
- Enabled clients to track **Google and Meta ad conversions across the entire booking funnel** by white-labeling reservations onto client-owned subdomains — building the multi-tenant routing and per-client DNS/SSL provisioning behind it.

Tally Meals — Lead Developer 2025 – Present

- Replaced a barely-functioning legacy .NET platform for Greek house meal management by leading a small team through a ground-up Ruby on Rails rebuild — owning architecture, servers, and CI/CD from first commit to launch, now serving chapters across **multiple universities**.
- Shipped **iOS and Android apps from a single Rails codebase** using Hotwire Native — members reserve meals and late plates against chef-published menus, with per-member allergy/dietary tracking, meal-plan limits and billing compliance, and printable kitchen prep lists.
- Carried every client's historical data through the replatform by converting the legacy **MSSQL database to PostgreSQL** — reverse-engineering the old schema and migrating chapters, members, meal plans, and reservation history into the new domain model.

Austin City Guide — Full-Stack Developer 2020 – Present

- Modernized a city guide platform running on a **~17-year-old .NET codebase** by rebuilding it from the ground up in Ruby on Rails as sole developer — maintaining and evolving it since.
- Achieved **rank #1 Google results for multiple competitive local keywords** by pairing the rebuild with aggressive on-page SEO — content structure, technical optimization, and performance work.
- Increased click-through rates on the site's highest-traffic pages by building in-house analytics and an A/B split-testing framework — measuring real user behavior, then iterating page layouts against live traffic.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science
Texas State University — San Marcos, TX

Skills

- Languages & Frameworks:** Ruby, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, Hotwire (Turbo & Stimulus), Hotwire Native
- Front End:** TailwindCSS, SASS/CSS, HTML
- Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MSSQL
- Infrastructure:** Linux, Dokku, Nginx, CI/CD
- Services & APIs:** Stripe, Twilio, Postmark, Telnx, Uber Direct